

PERIPHERALS GAMING HEADSETS

A good headset is key to having an edge over your competitors.

You can definitely play single player and multiplayer games with any pair of headphones. But if you want the extra edge, it's always best to go for the ones that boost certain aspects of the game audio. Of course, it's all based on your preference. Some love a bass-heavy signature for explosions while other prefer more emphasis on the mids and highs to discern footsteps. We used several gaming headsets to try and find the one that offered the best balanced signature and performance favourable for all kinds of games. Our candidates supported an exhaustive list of features and we considered both wireless and wired headsets. Headsets with bundled DSPs and even external amps were covered this year. Comfort and RGB lighting aside, here are the best performing gaming headsets we tested at our labs.

2017 ZERO1 AWARD WINNER

HyperX Revolver S

The HyperX Revolver S managed to maintain a brilliant balance in sound, and produce an almost flat signature with minor boosts to certain frequencies. The bass was right about enough to the point where it doesn't become overpowering. The wide soundstage delivered on this headset was the best, and games felt more immersive. Footsteps and gunshots from far away were audible easily and we didn't miss any sound from the environment. Not just games, the Revolver S is great for music because of its close-to-flat signature, ensuring that percussion instruments, vocals and strings, all of them sound great. Apart from all the good things in this headset, we expected a better microphone which was high-pitched and felt unnatural. In conclusion, the Zero1 award for the best gaming headset goes to the HyperX Revolver S.



HyperX Revolver S

Price: ₹11,999

RUNNER-UP

Logitech G433

The headsets that made it to the top four are so close that the differences in scores is in the decimal points. With a slightly lower audio performance score, the Logitech G433 comes in second to the Revolver S. Both of them offer impressive sound quality but the Revolver S performs slightly better in certain aspects. If you're a casual gamer and don't have much experience listening to many gaming headsets, you wouldn't even notice these subtle differences. In-game sounds like footsteps are distinguishable, although gunshots and explosions don't deliver the satisfying punch. The microphone is considerably better than the Revolver S. Only if the other sound reproduction aspects were better on this one, the G433 could have taken away the Zero1 award this year.



Logitech G433

Price: ₹8,995



ASUS Cerberus V2

Price: ₹5,700

BEST BUY

ASUS Cerberus V2

The Cerberus V2 will be loved by bass lovers since it was one of the few headsets where the bass level didn't make us feel uncomfortable after a while and still deliver punchy sound. For instance, continuous gunshots and vehicle sounds generally overpower voice communication but not on the Cerberus V2. Moreover, it's surprisingly good for listening to EDM and house music as well. The quality of the microphone wasn't the best, and during in-game sounds, the volume levels became too low. There weren't enough details picked up by the mic and it sounded below average. However, the Cerberus V2 has an attractive price of ₹5,700 while placing right below the Logitech G433 in performance. This makes it the Best Buy. 